

MERIDIAN LOGISTICS GmbH

Request for Proposal — Enterprise Cloud Infrastructure

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1. Company Overview

Meridian Logistics GmbH is a mid-large European logistics and supply chain management company headquartered in Frankfurt am Main, Germany. Founded in 1998, Meridian operates across 22 countries with a primary focus on automotive, pharmaceutical, and retail supply chains. With over 14,000 employees and annual revenue of approximately €2.8 billion, Meridian has become one of Germany's top ten logistics providers.

The company maintains regional headquarters in Munich, Warsaw, Barcelona, and Rotterdam. Meridian's core operations include freight forwarding, last-mile delivery, customs brokerage, cold-chain logistics, and enterprise supply chain visibility software.

2. Current Technology Landscape

Meridian currently operates a hybrid infrastructure combining on-premise data centres in Frankfurt and Munich with limited cloud workloads on a legacy private cloud provider. The technology stack includes:

- ERP: SAP S/4HANA (on-premise, version 2022)
- CRM: Salesforce Enterprise
- Collaboration: Microsoft 365 E5 (50,000+ licensed users)
- WMS: Manhattan Associates Warehouse Management System
- TMS: Oracle Transportation Management
- BI: SAP Analytics Cloud
- Identity: Azure Active Directory (federated)
- Network: MPLS with SD-WAN overlay across 22 countries
- Security: Palo Alto NGFW, CrowdStrike Falcon EDR

3. Purpose of This RFP

Meridian Logistics is initiating a strategic cloud transformation programme to migrate its core logistics workloads, data analytics platform, and customer-facing APIs to a hyperscale public cloud provider. This RFP is issued to evaluate five shortlisted cloud vendors: CloudPrime, NexaCloud, DataVault, SkyBridge, and OmegaCloud.

The selected vendor will become Meridian's primary cloud infrastructure partner for a minimum period of five years with total contract value estimated between €18 million and €32 million depending on scope.

4. Strategic Requirements

4.1 Mandatory Requirements (Must-Have)

Requirement	Category	Priority
GDPR Article 46 full compliance with data residency in EU	Legal/Compliance	CRITICAL
ISO 27001:2022 certification — active and auditable	Security	CRITICAL
SOC 2 Type II certification — valid certificate required	Security	CRITICAL
Frankfurt or Munich data centre availability	Infrastructure	CRITICAL
Native SAP S/4HANA certified infrastructure	Integration	CRITICAL
Azure Active Directory federation support (SAML 2.0)	Identity	CRITICAL
99.95% uptime SLA with financial penalties for breach	Reliability	CRITICAL

24/7 enterprise support with 1-hour P1 response SLA	Support	CRITICAL
Total annual cost under €7.2 million Year 1	Financial	CRITICAL

4.2 Preferred Requirements

- Kubernetes-native managed container orchestration (no additional tooling)
- ML/AI platform with GPU cluster support for demand forecasting models
- Multi-region active-active failover within EU
- FinOps tooling with cost allocation by business unit
- Dedicated Customer Success Manager and technical account management
- Carbon-neutral or carbon-negative data centres by 2026
- Marketplace integration with existing SAP and Salesforce licences
- Minimum 10 years vendor financial stability evidence

5. Evaluation Criteria and Weightings

Security & Compliance	30%	Certifications, audit rights, data sovereignty
Technical Architecture	25%	SAP fit, K8s, scalability, migration support
Total Cost of Ownership	20%	Y1-Y5 TCO, egress fees, support cost
Operational Excellence	15%	Support SLA, onboarding, uptime history
Strategic Partnership	10%	Roadmap, innovation, executive engagement

6. Budget and Commercial Framework

Meridian has approved a cloud infrastructure budget envelope of €34 million over five years. Year 1 spend ceiling is €7.2 million inclusive of migration, professional services, and production workload costs. Vendors must provide fixed pricing for Year 1 and indexed pricing for Years 2-5 with a maximum escalation cap of 4% per annum.

Payment terms: Net 60 days. Meridian requires quarterly invoicing with detailed cost breakdowns by service category and business unit. All pricing must be provided in EUR. Multi-year discounts are expected and will be evaluated as part of the financial scoring.

7. Risk and Compliance Requirements

- Vendor must undergo Meridian third-party security assessment (ISO 27001 gap analysis) prior to contract signing
- Data processing agreement (DPA) conforming to GDPR Article 28 required on Day 1
- Right to audit clause must be included — Meridian internal audit team access within 30 days notice
- Incident response SLA: P1 breach notification within 1 hour, root cause within 24 hours
- Vendor lock-in mitigation: open standards APIs, data portability guarantee, exit support clause
- Business continuity plan (BCP) documentation required for EU data centres
- Supply chain security: vendor must disclose all sub-processors operating within Meridian data scope

8. Timeline

RFP Issued to Vendors	May 2026
Vendor Questions Deadline	June 2, 2026
Proposals Due	June 20, 2026

Shortlist Announcement	July 4, 2026
Technical Presentations	July 14-18, 2026
Proof of Concept Period	August 2026
Contract Award	September 2026
Migration Start	October 2026

Contact: procurement@meridian-logistics.de | Procurement Director: Klaus Berger
Meridian Logistics GmbH | Mainzer Landstrasse 50, 60325 Frankfurt am Main